Welder and plasma cutter maintenance schedule

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For MIG, TIG and stick machines and shop plasma cutters. Most of it is quick: clean the tip and nozzle every day, check cables every few months, and blow the dust out of the machine before it builds up.

Typical intervals from manufacturer manuals and published service schedules. Your machine's manual comes first.

Daily

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
MIG: clean the nozzle, check the contact tip	Daily	Replace either one when worn	
Coil the gun cable loosely	Daily		
Shut off the shielding gas when done	Daily		
Plasma: check inlet air or gas pressure	Daily		
Plasma: inspect consumables, torch and torch lead	Daily	Replace consumables as needed	
Plasma: coolant level and condition	Daily	Liquid-cooled systems	

Weekly to monthly

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Plasma: leak test the gas lines	Weekly		
Tighten the work clamp lead and gun cable connections	Monthly		
Plasma: check ground and table-to-workpiece connections	Monthly	Clean, bare metal-to-metal contact	
Plasma: clean inside the power supply	Monthly	Qualified person; check contactors and relays	

Every 3 months

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Inspect weld cables, replace cracked ones	Every 3 months		
Clean and tighten weld terminals	Every 3 months		
Inspect gas hoses and fittings	Every 3 months		
Blow out the MIG gun liner	Every 3 months	Filtered compressed air; replace the liner when worn	
Replace unreadable labels	Every 3 months		

Every 6 months

TASK	HOW OFTEN	NOTES	✓
Blow out or vacuum inside the welder	Every 6 months	Power disconnected; monthly in heavy use	
Clean the wire drive rolls	Every 6 months		
Plasma: coolant system service	Every 6 months	Liquid-cooled systems; qualified person	

Service log: welder and plasma cutter

Machine / unit: _____ Make & model: _____

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DATE	NEXT DUE	WORK DONE	PARTS USED	INITIALS

Free printable from fleetoptima.org/maintenance-schedules